Zhongyuan Sun

Hitotsubashi Institute for Advanced Study, Hitotsubashi University
2-1 Naka, Kunitachi, Tokyo, Japan
a253135r@r.hit-u.ac.jp | zhongyuan0.github.io

Academic appointment

Specially Appointed Assistant Professor — Aug 2025 – present
Hitotsubashi Institute for Advanced Study, Hitotsubashi University, Tokyo

Education

PhD in Management — 2021 – 2026
City University of Hong Kong

MA in Finance — 2017 – 2019
Beijing Foreign Studies University

BA in Economics — 2013 – 2017
Wuhan University

Research interests

Business and society; social issues in management; responsible management; organization theory; entrepreneurship; social evaluation (e.g., authenticity, legitimacy); aesthetics; creative industries; large language models for business.

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Clark-Hamel, S., Bischoff, L., & **Sun, Z.** (2026). Bittersweet Symphony: A music theory approach to stakeholder dissonance and value creation. *Journal of Management*. Advance online publication. doi:10.1177/01492063261469450
Best Paper Award, Social Issues in Management, 85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management.

Sun, Z., Ren, Y., & Li, Y. (2026). The intellectual legacy of Erving Goffman in management studies: A citation context analysis. *Journal of Management History*, 32(2), 310–328. doi:10.1108/JMH-04-2024-0059

Shen, H., **Sun, Z.**, & Li, S. X. (2025). Optimal or detrimental? Distinctiveness in high risk aversion contexts. *Journal of Business Research*, 200, 115613. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2025.115613

Book chapter

Sun, Z. (2025). The future of organisational authenticity in the age of artificial intelligence. In M. Moussa & A. McMurray (Eds.), *The Palgrave handbook of breakthrough technologies in contemporary organisations* (pp. 81–91). Palgrave Macmillan. doi:10.1007/978-981-96-2516-1_7

Book reviews

Sun, Z. (2026). Review of *Democratizing luxury: Name brands, advertising, and consumption in modern Japan*, by Annika A. Culver. *Business History*. Advance online publication. doi:10.1080/00076791.2026.2700123

Sun, Z. (in preparation). Review of *Japan's anime revolution! Twenty animated films that changed the world*, by Jonathan Clements. Invited book review for the *Journal of Cultural Economy*.

Papers under review

Sun, Z., Ren, Y., & Wang, K. Who listens to the outsider? Heterogeneous audiences' evaluation of how outsiders frame their innovations. Under review at *Research Policy*.

Ren, Y., & **Sun, Z.** When pets are on the show: Ethical concerns in pet digital labor. Under review at *Journal of Business Ethics*.

Wang, K., Zhang, P., **Sun, Z.**, & Sheng, S. When to hit the recall button: CEO regulatory focus and the timing of recall. Revise and resubmit (first round), *Journal of Operations Management*.

Wang, K., Zhang, H., Zhang, P., & **Sun, Z.** Executives' military experience and pay disparities within firms: An imprinting perspective. Under review at *Journal of Business Research*.

Work in progress

Sun, Z., Ren, Y., & Karube, M. Immerse or escape? The paradoxical effect of authenticity on audience evaluation.

Sun, Z., & Ren, Y. Aesthetics as strategy.

Sun, Z., & Ren, Y. Radical innovation in creative industries.

Sun, Z., & Ren, Y. Reconstructing hope among involuntarily unemployed youth in China.

Sun, Z., & Ren, Y. Chinese blind entrepreneurs in the massage industry.

Sun, Z., Ren, Y., & Sgourev, S. No brand: Negative identity work in organizations.

Honors, awards and grants

Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (KAKENHI), Early-Career Scientists, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science; principal investigator (JPY 4,550,000) 2026 – 2029

Above and Beyond the Call of Duty (ABCD) Reviewer Award, OMT Division, Academy of Management 2026

Best Paper Award, Social Issues in Management, 85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management 2025

Best Paper Award, 6th China Marketing Strategy Forum 2025

Management History Division Travel Grant, Academy of Management (USD 575) 2025

Conference Grant, City University of Hong Kong (HKD 10,000) 2023

PhD Fellowship, College of Business, City University of Hong Kong 2021 – 2024

Master Students Academic Excellence Scholarship, Beijing Foreign Studies University (CNY 50,000) 2019

	BFSU Excellence Scholarship, Beijing Foreign Studies University (CNY 20,000)	2019
	Outstanding Graduate of Beijing Ordinary Colleges and Universities	2019
	Excellence Scholarship, Wuhan University	2016

Conference presentations and invited talks

32nd Annual Conference, Japan Academy of International Business Studies, Kyoto	Oct 2025
63rd Annual Conference, Academic Association for Organizational Science, Tokyo	Sep 2025
85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen	Jul 2025
41st European Group for Organizational Studies (EGOS) Colloquium, Athens	Jul 2025
11th IACMR Biennial Conference, Xi'an	Jun 2025
Annual Meeting of the Society for Business Ethics, Chicago (presented by co-author)	Aug 2024
ACEDE Congress, Valencia (presented by co-author)	Jun 2024
School of Economics and Management, Tsinghua University (virtual)	Dec 2023
83rd Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston	Aug 2023
39th European Group for Organizational Studies (EGOS) Colloquium, Cagliari	Jul 2023
Society for Cognitive Studies of the Moving Image Conference, Wilmington	May 2023
Sixth International Cultural Administration Conference, Beijing	Jul 2018

Teaching

Instructor

Strategic Management (undergraduate) City University of Hong Kong	Fall 2024
International Business (undergraduate) Beijing Foreign Studies University	Spring and Fall 2018

Guest lecture

Advanced Research Methods (graduate) Hitotsubashi University	Spring 2026

Teaching assistant

Strategic Management (undergraduate) City University of Hong Kong	Spring 2023
Strategy and Policy (undergraduate) City University of Hong Kong	Spring and Fall 2022

Professional service

Ad hoc reviewer, journals

Academy of Management Discoveries, *Administrative Science Quarterly*, *Journal of International Business Studies*, *Management and Organization Review*, *Research Policy*

Ad hoc reviewer, conferences

Academy of Management Annual Meeting (OMT, SIM, TIM and TLC Divisions)	2022 – present
IACMR Biennial Conference	2022 – present
European Academy of Management Annual Conference	2025 – present
Annual Conference of the Society for Business Ethics	2025 – present

Roles

Ambassador, Management History Division, Academy of Management	2025 – present
Research Storyteller, *Journal of Business Venturing Insights*	2025 – present
Volunteer, Management History Division, 85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management	2025
Paper session chair, 2025 IACMR Biennial Conference, Xi'an	2025
Coordinator, Brown Bag seminars (five sessions), City University of Hong Kong	2022 – 2023
Student volunteer, Academy of Management OMT YouTube Channel	2022 – 2023

Workshops and seminars

4th IIR Innovation Research Workshop, Hitotsubashi University	Aug 2026
Organization Science PDW, Hong Kong Polytechnic University	Dec 2025
Research Policy Special Issue PDW, The University of Hong Kong	Dec 2025
3rd IIR Innovation Research Workshop, Hitotsubashi University	Aug 2025
AOM PDW on the Future of Sociology in Management Scholarship, Copenhagen	Jul 2025
Future Directions in Methods for Social Evaluations in Organization Studies PDW, 41st EGOS Colloquium, Athens	Jul 2025
Pre-conference PhD Workshop, 41st EGOS Colloquium, Athens	Jul 2025
XVII Medici Summer School in Management Studies, HEC, France	Jun 2025
2nd *Management and Organization Review* PDW, Wuhan University	Dec 2024
Academy of Management Discoveries Paper Development Workshop (virtual)	Nov 2024
Organization Science Workshop, Singapore Management University	Nov 2024
Journal of Business Venturing Insights Bootcamp, City University of Hong Kong	Aug 2024

	Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal Pre-Submission Workshop on "Framing Novelty," Crete	Jul 2024
	Journal of Management Studies Publishing Workshop, Yokohama National University	May 2024
	Academy of Management Review Bridge Reviewer Program (virtual)	Nov 2023 – Dec 2024
	AOM Organizational Stigma PDW, Boston	Aug 2023
	Summer School in Stakeholder Theory, Darden School of Business, University of Virginia	Jul 2023
	Journal of Management Studies Special Issue Workshop, "Managing Social Evaluation in a Complex and Evolving World" (virtual)	Feb 2023
	Brown Bag Seminar, City University of Hong Kong	Dec 2022

Professional affiliations

Academy of Management (AOM)
European Group for Organizational Studies (EGOS)
International Association for Chinese Management Research (IACMR)
Academic Association for Organizational Science (AAOS)

Skills and languages

Stata, Python, R
Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic)